

at once by an effort of faith". Even more staggering is their strongly implied censure of those who refuse to 'swallow' and would assay to question and examine the crass hermeneutic procedures that produce things that have to be "swallowed".

It is not for nothing, that the "ghost of Karl Barth" has poked his nose into this discussion. The "New Modernism", (as Van Til called it), runs on the logic engine of contradiction, yet is couched in all the language of Reformed Theology, a Theology of the Word. Far wider than just Barth, it is nevertheless all powered by Hegelian dialecticism, and essentially proclaims faith as being belief in mutually simultaneous contradictories that are supra-logical to humans, viz. the Bible is the Word of God, and the Bible is the word of mere man full of errors and contradictions. All men are simultaneously elect and reprobate. Effectively, in our view, this makes it look as if God and His Word speak with a forked tongue. And in articulating this 'Barthian' system, the eminent Scots theologian T. F. Torrance, in speaking of faith in relation to the Word of God, has virtually re-articulated Spurgeon's viewpoint here, thus:

"To suspend judgment is not to be irrational; rather it is the part of reason which behaves obediently in terms of its object, in this instance, an objective Revelation which even in the event of Revelation remains a *mysterion*, and will not yield its secret to analytical and logical investigation". (T.F.Torrance: Review of Warfield's "*The Inspiration and Authority of the Bible*" in: The Scottish Journal of Theology, Vol 7, 1954, page 106, cited in Fere: "*Language, Logic, and God*", Fontana 1970, page 131).

Note the "mysterion" here. And note "an objective Revelation which even in the event of Revelation remains a mysterion...." Even "Revelation" is still a mystery, before which human analytical thinking is to be suspended, indeed, is stymied. How chillingly parallel to the words of CHS who, in this sermon tells us, with respect to the "contradictions" his exegesis throws up from God's Word, "Let the difficult doctrines go down whole into your very soul, by a grand exercise of faith", and that such "must not be chewed by perpetual questioning". (Murray, Op.Cit. p.153). All this of course begs the question: "Is this Revelation Revelation?" How can it be Revelation if all it manifests is a contradiction that stonewalls rational understanding, i.e., a "mysterion"? But across this epistemological gap Barthian faith has to "leap", never mind the contradictions, never mind the "mysterion", "believe it" (despite Barth's protestations that he did not teach "a leap of faith"), and the kinship to Spurgeon's dictum to be "swallowed at once" is immediately evident. No wonder hosts of erstwhile Calvinist preachers have gone on a one-way excursion down Hegel Street in the last fifty years. If you can "swallow" Spurgeon's kind of exegesis, well it's easy to go on and "swallow" Barth, after all, his contradictions are, if more numerous, each less of a mouthful than this gargantuan dollop CHS bids us ingest "by an effort of faith".

In conclusion, let the reader judge again, who in these matters has been treating 1 Tim. 2 : 4 with, in Spurgeon's own words, "grammatical gunpowder" and "exploding it by way of expounding it" ? The likes of Dr. Gill? The likes of Calvin and the classical Reformed exeges? Or is it none other than dear Mr. CHS himself?

Editor.

"But the present discourse relates to **classes** of men, and not to individual persons; for his sole object is, to include in this number princes and foreign nations."

John Calvin